

SCIENCE OF READING REVIEW: LYON COLLEGE

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: Date not reported

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

This report uses evidence from an on-site review to examine how an educator preparation program prepares candidates to teach reading using scientific reading instruction, as Arkansas requires of every approved program. It is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

The on-site reviews are carried out by Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US), an external review organization. TPI-US teams inspect coursework and course materials, observe instruction and clinical practice, review program data, and hold focus groups with candidates, faculty, mentor teachers, and school partners. Division of Elementary and Secondary Education staff participate in the review.

TPI-US rates the program in the three review areas of the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

- Review Area 1, "Quality of Literacy Coursework," is rated from course materials, syllabi, assignments, and observations of instruction.
- Review Area 2, "Quality of Field-Based Experiences," is rated from placement records, observation and feedback evidence, and focus groups with candidates, mentor teachers, faculty, and school partners.
- Review Area 3, "Quality of Performance Management and Continuous Improvement," is rated from program data systems, quality-control checkpoints, monitoring practice, and partnership evidence.

Every review area receives a rating. Depending on the framework version, the report may also rate each criterion; some earlier reports discuss every criterion without stating a separate rating for it. Performance Levels are defined as follows, in language drawn from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

PERFORMANCE LEVEL	WHAT THE RATING MEANS
4 — EXCEEDS	Coursework and training CONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
3 — MEETS	Coursework and training USUALLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
2 — APPROACHING	Coursework and training INCONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
1 — BELOW	Coursework and training RARELY OR DO NOT address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.

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REVIEW AREA PERFORMANCE LEVELS		
REVIEW AREA 1 LITERACY COURSEWORK	REVIEW AREA 2 FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES	REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT
APPROACHING	BELOW	BELOW
CRITERIA REVIEWED		
9	11	7
CORRECTIVE ACTION STATUS		
Corrective action plan in place for this review cycle. This program is carrying out a corrective action plan with the Division covering seventeen actions.		

PROGRAM INFORMATION

INSTITUTION NAME	Lyon College
LOCATION	Batesville, Arkansas
PROGRAM REVIEWED	Educator preparation program, literacy
PATHWAY	Traditional
REVIEW FRAMEWORK	TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024)
REVIEWING BODY	Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US)
SITE VISIT DATES	Not reported

REVIEW AREA 1: QUALITY OF LITERACY COURSEWORK

REVIEW AREA 1 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
APPROACHING 9 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Overview of the science of reading	Meets
Concepts of print instruction	Approaching
Collaborative communication, oral language instruction	Approaching
Phonological and phonemic awareness instruction	Approaching
Phonics, orthography, automatic word recognition instruction	Approaching
Fluency instruction	Approaching
Vocabulary instruction	Approaching
Text comprehension instruction	Approaching
Writing instruction	Approaching
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that EDU 320 Teaching Reading gave candidates explicit instruction in the science of reading through Reading Rockets, the National Reading Panel's five components, and Arkansas R.I.S.E. modules covering Scarborough's Reading Rope, the Simple View of Reading, the Four-Part Processing Model, and Ehri's phases of word reading development. That criterion met expectations and the other eight approached it. Coursework introduced concepts of print and the 44 English phonemes, and vocabulary instruction extended into EDU 330 Literacy in the Disciplines through Marzano's six-step process. Reviewers found gaps in the phonological awareness continuum, phoneme to grapheme mapping, the six syllable types, listening comprehension, and the writing process. Candidates seldom administered literacy assessments.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Embed structured opportunities to learn about, administer, and analyze literacy assessments aligned to each subcomponent of reading development • Provide more explicit, practice-based instruction on how to support diverse learners	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Eight of the seventeen corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 2: QUALITY OF FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES

REVIEW AREA 2 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
BELOW 11 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Selection of clinical placement schools	Below
Selection of cooperating teachers (mentor teachers)	Approaching
Opportunities to observe models of effective early literacy practice	Approaching
Field-based placements provide opportunities to use HQIM	Approaching
Responsibilities build to candidate readiness for full responsibility	Approaching
Opportunities to apply learning about multilingual children	Below
Opportunities to apply learning about students who experience difficulty reading	Below
Mentor teachers are skillful and can coach candidates	Approaching
Faculty and supervisors guide and evaluate candidates through training	Below
Quality of written and oral feedback	Below
Student engagement and candidate impact on student learning	Meets
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that the program partnered with eight elementary placement schools, one rated B, six rated C, and one rated D, and selected sites primarily by geographic proximity rather than instructional effectiveness or learner diversity. Mentor teacher criteria required three years of experience and an effective rating but did not assess capacity to coach science of reading instruction. Partner sites used varying materials, including some that did not meet state criteria. Reviewers found that placements with multilingual learners occurred by chance, that preparation for students with dyslexia was limited, that supervisors and mentor teachers received no calibration training, and that written feedback did not build on prior observations or connect to student learning.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Expand shared, ongoing training for university supervisors and mentor teachers, aligned to the science of reading • Define a practicum and residency experience with consistent expectations for districts, mentor teachers, university supervisors, and candidates	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Seven of the seventeen corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 3: QUALITY OF PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
BELOW 7 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Quality of data the program collects and uses	Below
Internal quality control gates (or checkpoints) and intervention plans	Below
Quality of monitoring	Below
Monitoring coursework quality, teaching quality, and clinical connections	Approaching
Quality improvement planning	Below
Partnerships improve candidate experiences with HQIM	Below
Evaluation of partnerships for readiness to teach early literacy	Below
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that the program collected grade point averages, dispositions, Foundations of Reading Praxis scores, mentor teacher evaluations, field experience checklists, stakeholder surveys, and observation forms, but that none of these measures captured literacy-specific skills or science of reading implementation. Individual faculty monitored their own courses and the university supervisor tracked written feedback, which left data fragmented with no program-level cycle for synthesis. Quality control gates rested on grade point average benchmarks at practicum and residency with no literacy-specific checkpoints, though a flagging system and a structured intervention process existed. Memoranda of understanding carried no literacy commitments or data-sharing terms.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Establish a structured process for identifying, collecting, and reviewing literacy-specific data sources • Establish a system for evaluating literacy coursework and monitoring candidate performance across all literacy subcomponents	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Three of the seventeen corrective actions target this review area.	

CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN

Where a review identifies findings that require follow-up, the program develops a corrective action plan with the Division of Elementary and Secondary Education. The recommendations under each review area above are the reviewers' advice; the plan below is the program's formal response, monitored by the Division. Actions are grouped by the review area whose findings prompted them.

TOTAL ACTIONS	HIGH PRIORITY	MEDIUM PRIORITY	LOW PRIORITY
17	14	3	0

The plan sets out 17 corrective actions: 14 high priority and 3 medium priority. The priorities are the plan's own. Some actions target more than one review area, so the per-area counts shown under each review area add to more than the total.

ACTIONS THE PROGRAM IS TAKING

PRIORITY	ACTION	FINDING THAT REQUIRED IT	SUCCESS METRICS
HIGH RA1	Embed structured literacy assessment training across all subcomponents (administer, analyze, plan)	RA1 program recommendation: assessments aligned to each subcomponent	≥90% candidates proficient on assessment analysis rubric; plans include targeted next steps matched to need
HIGH RA1	Strengthen coursework differentiation for diverse learners (MLL, neurodiverse, varied processing/language needs)	RA1 recommendation: diverse learners supports	Candidates demonstrate at least 2 evidence-based scaffolds per lesson; supervisors verify differentiation in observed lessons
MEDIUM RA1	Build a consistent phonological awareness continuum + assessment-to-instruction routine	RA1: Phonological & phonemic awareness (Approaching)	≥85% candidates proficient on PA lesson + assessment task
HIGH RA1	Strengthen phonics/orthography/word recognition instruction (phoneme-grapheme mapping; six syllable types; multisyllabic progression)	RA1: Phonics/orthography/AWR (Approaching)	Candidates proficient on structured phonics delivery rubric; plans show developmental progression
MEDIUM RA1	Standardize ORF (fluency) assessment and build tiered fluency instruction practice	RA1: Fluency (Approaching)	Candidates accurately score ORF and propose aligned interventions; field artifacts show differentiated fluency supports
MEDIUM RA1	Strengthen vocabulary across listening/speaking/reading/writing and add vocabulary assessment-to-instruction	RA1: Vocabulary (Approaching)	Candidates plan Tier II/III vocabulary with assessment-informed adjustments
HIGH RA1	Make comprehension instruction more practice-based (purpose for reading; listening comprehension; HQIM-aligned planning; data use)	RA1: Comprehension (Approaching)	Observations show explicit strategy instruction + text evidence; candidates use data to differentiate

PRIORITY	ACTION	FINDING THAT REQUIRED IT	SUCCESS METRICS
HIGH RA1	Expand writing instruction as a coherent strand (process + transcription + sentence/paragraph work + feedback)	RA1: Writing (Approaching)	≥90% candidates proficient on writing instruction rubric; candidates analyze and respond to student writing
HIGH RA2	Redesign clinical placement selection to include high-performing/improving sites and more MLL access	RA2: Placement school selection (Below)	% placements meeting criteria increases annually; all candidates have documented MLL exposure (in person or simulated)
HIGH RA2, RA3	Ensure all placements provide state-approved HQIM and required HQIM practice	RA2: HQIM access/use (Approaching); RA3 partnerships (Below)	100% candidates complete HQIM lesson internalization + delivery requirement
HIGH RA2	Define a scaffolded practicum-to-residency literacy progression with required experiences	RA2: Practicum/residency expectations (Approaching)	100% candidates complete all required experiences; artifacts meet proficiency
HIGH RA2	Ensure candidates practice instruction for MLL literacy development (in-classroom or simulated)	RA2: MLL application (Below)	All candidates demonstrate proficiency on MLL literacy support rubric
HIGH RA2	Ensure candidates practice tiered supports for students with reading difficulties (dyslexia; Tier I/II)	RA2: Reading difficulties/dyslexia application (Below)	Candidates proficient on tiered instruction rubric; evidence of student response to instruction
HIGH RA2	Adopt one standardized literacy-focused observation + feedback tool and train/calibrate all evaluators	RA2: Training/calibration (Below); RA2 feedback quality (Below)	Reliability improves; reduced variability in feedback quality
HIGH RA2	Standardize feedback so it is cumulative, instruction-focused, student-evidence-based, and goal-linked	RA2: Quality of written/oral feedback (Below)	≥90% feedback samples meet rubric; candidates implement next steps by next observation
HIGH RA3	Build RA3 literacy-specific data system, checkpoints, and semester monitoring cycle	RA3: Data quality (Below); monitoring (Below); control gates (Below)	Evidence of term-by-term decisions tied to literacy data; improved candidate proficiency over time
HIGH RA3	Update MOUs and partnership evaluation to include SoR/HQIM expectations and accountability	RA3: Partnerships/HQIM alignment (Below); partnership evaluation (Below)	100% active partners meet minimum expectations; targeted support plans for sites below threshold

OVERSIGHT

Each action in the plan carries an evidence requirement and a framework criterion it answers to. The plan presents its success metrics as suggested measures rather than settled targets, and the program supplies the responsible owner and the completion timeline for each action when it returns the plan to the Division. Those owner and timeline entries are not recorded in the plan as issued and are therefore not published here.

Sources: TPI-US Written Report & Recommendations, Lyon College, conducted under the TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024). Lyon College Arkansas Science of Reading (SoR) Corrective Action Plan, Arkansas DESE. Rating scale language quoted from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework.